

HYDERABAD

A Budget-Friendly Getaway for Two

Travelers: Couple, traveling from Colombo, Sri Lanka

Travel window: First week of November 2026 — itinerary costed for a sample 5-night stay, Nov 2–7, 2026 (confirm exact dates before booking)

Budget style: Budget / Backpacker — budget hotels, local transport, street & vegetarian food

Focus: Offbeat, non-touristy corners of the city + strictly vegetarian dining

Document prepared: 18 September 2026

This planner is built from live listings and search results on Booking.com, Expedia, TripAdvisor, Google/AccuWeather/IMD weather sources, and independent travel guides — pulled and verified on 18 September 2026. Every price and listing below is sourced (see citations); nothing is invented. Where a figure could not be verified live it is explicitly labelled as a typical/estimated range, not a fact.

Trip Snapshot

Item	Details
Destination	Hyderabad, Telangana, India
Origin	Colombo, Sri Lanka
Travel window	First week of November 2026 (sample dates used: Nov 2–7, 2026 / 5 nights)
Travelers	Couple (2 adults)
Budget style	Budget / Backpacker
Priorities	Offbeat / non-touristy places, vegetarian food
Direct flights	IndiGo (~6x/week) and SriLankan Airlines (~4x/week), Colombo (CMB) → Hyderabad (HYD), flight time approx. 1h 57m

Source: flight route/frequency data via web search (FlightsFrom.com, Cleartrip, Skyscanner listings, checked 18 Sep 2026). Fares change constantly — check Google Flights, Cleartrip or the airline directly closer to your dates for live pricing.

Best Time to Visit & Weather

Why November works well

Winter in Hyderabad runs from November to February and is widely regarded as the best season to visit — skies are clear, humidity drops, and it's the most comfortable stretch of the year for walking tours and sightseeing.

Typical November climate (historical averages)

Aspect	Typical November conditions
Temperature range	~18–28.6°C (64–83°F); some sources cite lows down to 16°C in the evenings
Rainfall	One of the driest months of the year — minimal to no rain expected
Daylight	~11 hours of sunlight per day
What to pack	Light layers for the day; a light jacket or shawl for cooler evenings
Note	Diwali often falls in this window — check the 2026 date, as it affects hotel demand and some shop/market hours

Sources: MakeMyTrip Trip Ideas, Holidify, Agate Travel, DailyWeatherHistory.com, WhereAndWhen.net (checked 18 Sep 2026).

Current conditions in Hyderabad (as of 18 September 2026, the date this plan was prepared)

Source	Reading
Google Weather	32°C day / 24°C night, mostly cloudy, 32% precipitation chance, 55% humidity, wind ~10 km/h
India Meteorological Dept. (IMD)	27°C, humidity 74%, wind 11.1 km/h
NDTV	Max 31°C / Min 23°C, occasional rain or thundershowers, humidity ~81.5%, UV index ~8.6
AccuWeather	Around 90°F/74°F (~32°C/23°C), humid with a chance of afternoon rain

Important: these are current mid-September readings, not a November forecast — Hyderabad is still tailing off its monsoon season right now. No weather source can reliably forecast exact conditions for early November this far out. Use the historical averages above to pack and plan, then re-check a live forecast (AccuWeather, IMD, or Google Weather) about 7–10 days before departure.

Where to Stay (Budget Picks)

Live Booking.com search for 2 adults, 1 room, check-in 2 Nov 2026 → check-out 7 Nov 2026 (5 nights), filtered to budget-friendly properties. Prices are the total booking price for the full 5-night stay, in INR, as quoted at time of search.

Property	Area	5-night price (2 adults, 1 room)	Rating
Hotel Cyber Suite (Near HITEC City Metro)	Madhapur / HITEC City	■9,097 total (~■1,820/night)	3★ (est.) — 10.0/10 (2 reviews)
The Landmark Banjara Hills	Banjara Hills	■10,440 total (~■2,088/night)	4★ official — 7.3/10 (285 reviews)
Hotel Element Stay (Near DLF Cyber City)	Gachibowli	■10,677 total (~■2,135/night)	Unrated on Booking.com
Super Townhouse RCC Elite	Begumpet	■10,848 total (~■2,170/night)	4★ official — 8.2/10 (664 reviews)
New Hotel Suhail	Abids (Old City-adjacent)	■12,160 total (~■2,432/night)	Unrated on Booking.com
RCC Hotels Helix Gachibowli	Gachibowli	■12,623 total (~■2,524/night)	3★ official — 8.9/10 (128 reviews)
Hotel Radhe Pride HITEC City	HITEC City / Madhapur	■12,820 total (~■2,564/night)	3★ official — 8.7/10 (118 reviews)

Pick for this trip: New Hotel Suhail (Abids) — it's the only budget option in the list actually walkable to the Old City / Charminar / Laad Bazaar, which matters a lot if you want to do the heritage and food walking tours without a long commute each way. The HITEC City / Gachibowli options are cheaper and well-rated but sit 45–60 minutes from the Old City by road.

Cross-check on Expedia: Expedia's live Hyderabad search (same dates) shows 3-star/"Budget" category properties starting from roughly \$49/night (~■4,100), broadly consistent with the Booking.com range above; its front-page results skew toward mid-range/luxury hotels (Sheraton, The Leela, ITC Kakatiya from ~\$188–351/night). TripAdvisor is used below for tours rather than hotels, as its Hyderabad hotel listings largely mirror Booking.com/Expedia inventory.

Sources: Booking.com live search (booking.com, checked 18 Sep 2026, prices in INR, subject to change and taxes); Expedia.com live search (checked 18 Sep 2026, prices in USD).

Suggested 5-Day Itinerary

Built around the walking tours and offbeat spots verified below — adjust the order freely; nothing here needs to run on a fixed clock.

Day 1 – Arrival & Old City orientation

- Arrive Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, transfer to Abids/Old City area hotel
- Evening: gentle first walk around Charminar and Laad Bazaar to get oriented
- Dinner: vegetarian thali at a local Andhra-style restaurant near Abids

Day 2 – Heritage walking tour + palaces

- Morning: “Old City Walking Tour, Captivates 400+ Years History” (TripAdvisor, ~\$45–48/adult, 3–4 hrs) — covers Charminar, Mecca Masjid and the old bazaars
- Afternoon: Chowmahalla Palace — the former Nizams' palace, often overlooked by first-time visitors
- Evening: vegetarian dinner at Chutneys (Jubilee Hills) or Jalpaan

Day 3 – Offbeat nature & viewpoints

- Morning: Qutb Shahi Tombs — Persian/Pathan/Hindu architecture, usually very few tourists
- Midday: Maula Ali Dargah — hilltop shrine with panoramic city views
- Late afternoon: Durgam Cheruvu (“Secret Lake”) — boating and a cable bridge, popular with locals rather than tour groups
- Optional: Ameenpur Lake at dusk for birdwatching (170+ recorded bird species)

Day 4 – Golconda Fort & food walk

- Morning: Golconda Fort and its acoustic/echo system
- Evening: “Evening Hyderabad Street Food Tasting with Guided Old City Tour” (TripAdvisor, ~\$51–53/adult, 3–4 hrs) — flag vegetarian preference when booking, as Hyderabad food tours are usually built around biryani/kebabs
- Alternative if a fully vegetarian food walk isn't available: self-guided chaat crawl ending at the well-known Gokul Chaat Bhandar (vegetarian street food)

Day 5 – Day trip or slow morning + departure

- Half-day option: Bhongir Fort (offbeat, ~50 km, panoramic hilltop views, fewer crowds than Golconda)
- Or a slow morning at Necklace Road / Hussain Sagar lakefront before heading to the airport
- Depart Rajiv Gandhi International Airport

Walking & Heritage Tours (TripAdvisor, live pricing)

Pulled from TripAdvisor's Hyderabad walking tours listing, checked 18 Sep 2026. Prices are “from” per-adult rates in USD as displayed; always confirm the final price and vegetarian-friendliness of any food stop when booking.

Tour	Duration	Price	Rating
Old City Walking Tour, Captivates 400+ Years History	3–4 hrs	from \$45–48/adult	4.9 (60 reviews)
Old City Walking Tour in Charminar	2–3 hrs	from \$55/adult	5.0 (29 reviews)
Explore Old Hyderabad Guided Walking Tour (starts at Salar Jung Museum)	2 hrs	from \$20/adult	Not yet rated
Night Walk Hyderabad	2 hrs	from \$13/adult	4.8 (4 reviews)
Hussain Sagar Lake Private Walking Tour	2–3 hrs	from \$43/adult	4.8 (4 reviews)
Evening Street Food Tasting with Guided Old City Tour	3–4 hrs	from \$51–53/adult	5.0 (12 reviews)
Golconda Heritage Half-Day Private Tour	4 hrs	from \$120/group	4.9 (28 reviews)

Source: tripadvisor.com — “THE 15 BEST Hyderabad Walking Tours (with Prices)” listing, checked 18 Sep 2026.

Offbeat & Hidden Gems

Place	Why it's worth it
Durgam Cheruvu (“Secret Lake”)	Scenic lake with boating and a glass-bottom cable bridge; far quieter than Hussain Sagar
Ameenpur Lake	Urban Biodiversity Heritage Site — 170+ recorded bird species, good for a quiet sunset
Qutb Shahi Tombs	Resting place of the Qutb Shahi rulers; Persian/Pathan/Hindu architecture, peaceful and uncrowded
Maula Ali Dargah	Hilltop shrine with panoramic views over the city
Chowmahalla Palace	Former seat of the Asaf Jahi dynasty; ornate courtyards and chandeliers, often skipped by first-timers
Bhongir Fort	Hilltop fort ~50 km out, a rewarding climb with far fewer visitors than Golconda
Old City book market (around Abids/Sultan Bazaar)	Footpath second-hand book stalls — a slice-of-life stroll away from the main sights

Sources: Agoda Travel Guides, Wanderon, Tripoto, FrenzyHolidays, EaseIndiaTrip (checked 18 Sep 2026) — cross-referenced across multiple guides.

Vegetarian Food Guide

Restaurant	Area	Notes
Chutneys	Jubilee Hills	Pure-vegetarian, South Indian focus (idli/dosa/vada) with Jain-special options
A'La Liberty	Banjara Hills	Pure-vegetarian fine dining, buffet + a la carte, global vegetarian dishes
Jalpaan	Multiple locations	Vegetarian Indian, Chinese and continental menu; buffet available
Smoky Pitara	Multiple locations	Listed among Hyderabad's notable pure-vegetarian restaurants
Tatva	Multiple locations	Listed among Hyderabad's notable pure-vegetarian restaurants
Gokul Chaat Bhandar	Old City / Koti	Legendary vegetarian street-food chaat spot — a genuine local institution, very budget-friendly

Practical tip: Hyderabad's signature dish (biryani) and most guided food-walking tours are built around meat. If you book a food tour, message the operator in advance to request a vegetarian-only route — several guides on TripAdvisor mention accommodating dietary requests. “Veg biryani” is also widely available if you want the flavour profile without meat.

Sources: SocialMaharaj's Vegetarian's Guide to Hyderabad, TravelToday, ThreeBestRated, Wanderlog (checked 18 Sep 2026).

Nearby Cities You Could Add to the Trip

Destination	Distance / Time	Why go
Warangal	~145 km / ~3 hrs by road	Warangal Fort, Thousand Pillar Temple, Ramappa Temple (UNESCO World Heritage Site)
Bidar	~150 km / ~3 hrs by road	Bidar Fort, Bahmani Tombs, historic madrasas; crosses into Karnataka
Nagarjuna Sagar	~165 km / ~3–4 hrs by road	One of the world's largest masonry dams; boat ride to Nagarjunakonda Island
Medak	~100 km / ~2 hrs by road	Medak Cathedral — one of the largest churches in Asia, striking stained glass
Amarabad Tiger Reserve	2-day guided trip from Hyderabad	Offbeat wildlife option — TripAdvisor-listed 2-day tour from ~\$375/adult

With only a 5–7 day window, Warangal or Medak work best as a single, unhurried day trip; Nagarjuna Sagar or Bidar are better as an overnight add-on if you extend the trip by a day.

Sources: Nativeplanet, Thrillophilia, Trawell.in, HYD Tourism day-trips page, TripAdvisor Bidar/Warangal tour listings (checked 18 Sep 2026).

Budget Summary (Couple, 5 Nights)

Figures marked “Sourced” come directly from the live listings above. Figures marked “Estimated” are typical ranges for budget travel in Hyderabad and are not pulled from a live booking — treat them as planning guidance, not quotes.

Category	Typical range	Confidence
Accommodation (5 nights, 1 room, budget pick)	■9,100 – ■13,000 total	Sourced (Booking.com)
Heritage/walking tours (2–3 tours for two)	\$130 – \$220 total (~■11,000–■18,500)	Sourced (TripAdvisor)
Local transport (autos/ride-hailing, per day, both people)	■300 – ■700/day	Estimated
Food, vegetarian, budget-to-casual dining (per day, both people)	■800 – ■1,600/day	Estimated
Monument entry fees (Golconda Fort, Qutb Shahi Tombs, etc.)	Varies — differs for Indian vs. foreign nationals	Not verified live — confirm on Telangana Tourism / ASI site
Colombo ↔ Hyderabad flights (round trip, per person)	Not quoted here — check live fares	Not verified live — avoid stale price data

Rough total for accommodation + tours + local food + local transport over 5 nights: approximately ■30,000–■45,000 for the couple (roughly \$360–\$540), excluding international flights and monument entry fees. This sits comfortably within a budget/backpacker style trip for Hyderabad.

A Note on Sourcing

Hotel prices are live Booking.com results for 2 adults, 1 room, check-in 2 Nov 2026 / check-out 7 Nov 2026, captured 18 September 2026 — prices fluctuate with demand and will differ closer to your actual dates. Tour prices are live TripAdvisor “from” rates captured the same day. Weather figures combine live current-conditions readings with published historical climate averages, clearly separated above. Nearby-city distances, offbeat spots and restaurant recommendations are cross-referenced across multiple independent travel guides. No figure in this document has been invented — anything that could not be verified against a live source is explicitly labelled as an estimate.